



SOUND EDITING

Do you have a problem rummaging through your old cassettes, or flipping through a dusty stack of records, reading them label by label before playing one of your favourite songs? With a little effort and some help from sound editing software such as Adobe Audition, you could record your old favourites onto your own PC at home, and have instant access to them in the future.

There are two editing modes in Audition—Multi Track and Edit. Multi Track is where you can lay down multiple files, mix them, etc. Edit view is the wave editor where you work with one file at a time. In the capacity we are using Audition, our primary concern will be the latter.

The Play/Pause, Record, and other buttons are well-placed. Zoom options include zooming into the selected area, and the start or end of the selection.

Recording in Audition is a breeze. Press the record button, and a dialog box comes up, asking you to define audio settings—there are options all the way up to 192 KHz 32-bit Stereo. Click OK to start recording. Whilst recording, the time-line cursor scrolls across the screen, with a realtime waveform generated behind it. Once you're done with the recording, move over to editing in the same Edit view. Switch to the

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Adobe Audition (Formerly Cool Edit Pro 2.1)

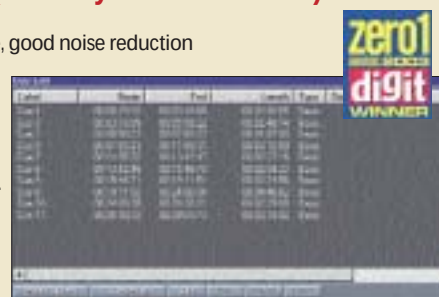
+ Recording is a breeze, good noise reduction

– Selecting and moving around is not very intuitive

Price: \$249

Web site: <http://www.adobe.com/products/audition>

Reviewed In: September 2003



PREVIOUS WINNERS

2002: Sound Forge 6.0

2001: Cakewalk Pro Audio 9, Soundforge 5

effects tab on the left, from where you can access most of the required functions. You can apply lots of cool effects such as pitch bending, delays and reverbs.

When it came to noise reduction, Audition performed very well. Most of the noise was removed without much change in the original audio. The cleaned up audio did have a tinny ring to it, but it was pretty good.

WORTHY MENTIONS

SoundForge 6

+ Quick response time

– Lacks multi-track editing, need plug-in for noise reduction

Price: \$349.97

Web site: <http://www.sonicfoundry.com/>

Reviewed In: September 2003

Audacity

+ Free

– Unstable at times, some operations take too many steps

Price: Free

Web site: <http://audacity.sourceforge.net>

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